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ELECTION 2026

Pritzker, Stratton win



Gov. JB Pritzker speaks on election night Tuesday at Navy Pier in Chicago. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Across the Chicago area, voters turned out for a busy day at polls

By Sam Charles, Jane Miller, Shun Graves and Joe Mahr
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A cheer erupted at Toman Library in Little Village when Deisy Alvarez turned in her ballot Tuesday and was announced as a first-time voter.

"We need them," election judge Marta Resendiz told a reporter, "to keep coming every time."

Across the Chicago area, first-time voters joined those who have voted for decades in turning Tuesday into a busy day at polls, following heavy returns of mail-in ballots and early voting that election officials said collectively appeared on track to surpass voter turnout in the last midterm elections.

Some Chicago precincts ran out of ballots — some early in the morning — forcing the Chicago Board of Election Commissioners to print up new ballots Tuesday and deliver them, an agency spokesperson said. In the meantime, some voters were forced to wait longer for touch-screen voting machines, come back to their precinct later or go to "universal" sites — one in each ward and the downtown "supersite."

The supersite itself saw waits swell beyond two hours, with lines by late afternoon starting 2½ blocks away.

Those who voted across the region cited civic duty mixed with hope their vote could help send a message about the direction they want the government to take.

For Alvarez, she said she was reluctant to vote in previous elections because she didn't feel like her vote would make a difference, but the presence of immigration agents in her neighborhood made her feel

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Voters hand Trump stunning rebuke

Democrats have retaken control of the U.S. Senate, delivering a decisive rebuke of Republican control of governance in Washington and ushering in a new era of congressional resistance to President Donald Trump.
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ONLINE: For the latest results, go to **chicagotribune.com/election-results**

Governor elected to 3rd term, his 2-time running mate now senator

CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Democrats continued their stranglehold on major statewide offices Tuesday as Gov. JB Pritzker was reelected to a rare third term as Illinois' top executive and Juliana Stratton, his former two-time running mate, was elected the state's junior U.S. senator, replacing retiring Dick Durbin.

The Associated Press called both races as soon as the polls closed at 7 p.m. Pritzker once again defeated Republican Darren Bailey in a rematch that held even less suspense than Pritzker's trouncing of the former downstate GOP lawmaker four years ago. Also running, as an independent, was former Republican political operative Collin Corbett.

By defeating former Illinois Republican Chair Don Tracy, Stratton has risen from a political outsider just 10 years ago to the nation's highest legislative body. Stratton was the favorite as the Democratic nominee, facing Republican Don Tracy, a former chairman of the Illinois Republican Party.

Both wins were significant for Pritzker, who not only became the first Democratic governor ever elected to three terms but whose political backing, as well as $10 million in financial support for Stratton's campaign, were critical to her emerging from a bruising three-way Democratic primary in March.

As results continued to pour in on election night as of press time, the Tribune was still following many other races and tabulating results.

Readers can find the latest at chicagotribune.com/election-results/. The Tribune is also offering up-to-date stories about races

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Device helps break 'habit loops'

Chicago-based Brick is the latest bet against screen addiction

By Jane Miller
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A magnetic gray box, no larger than a Post-it note, rests on the refrigerator in Sammy Mousa's Hyde Park apartment, holding up a maroon University of Chicago Law School flag. The word "Brick" is imprinted on the square's surface.

On his way to class in the morning, Mousa, 26, taps his phone on the device, in the same way he would tap to pay at a restaurant. Doing so instantly locks him out of Reddit, Netflix, YouTube, Twitter, Snapchat and Instagram.

"The usual suspects," Mousa said.

He then heads to class, with no way of getting back into those apps



Sammy Mousa, a first-year University of Chicago Law School student, holds up his Brick device at his Hyde Park apartment on Oct. 28. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

until he comes home and taps his phone on the device again.

The Brick, invented in early 2023, is the latest attempt at limiting screen time and fighting phone addiction. When making contact with a phone, the device locks users out of certain apps and does not allow them back in until they physically tap the phone on the device again.

"I don't know the founders, I have never seen their faces," said Mousa, who has been a loyal user for the past two years. "But it seemed like they had a good cause for starting this, and they actually found a problem that a lot of people suffer from."

Just 10 miles across the city, Brick's creators, 26-year-old TJ Driver and 27-year-old Zach Nasgowitz, can be found at the company headquarters in River North. The Milwaukee-raised childhood best friends invented the device in Nasgowitz's basement, and moved the startup to Chicago in 2024 after it went viral. With a staff of roughly 40 people who are all users, their office is

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INSIDE



BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'Embrace the moment'

New defensive tackle Jeffery Simmons was every bit as good as the Bears could have hoped in the Bears' 34-17 win over the Seahawks on Monday night. In just his first 10 snaps, he had a sack, a pressure of Seattle quarterback Sam Darnold and three tackles. **Sports**

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